PPE Guidance for Theatres – COVID 19, October 30th 2020

These are in line with updated recommendations from Public Health Wales, Public Health England, NICE Guidance and BCUHB.

Patients/Individuals treatment, care and support is to be managed within specifically identified 3 COVID-19 pathways:

• **High & medium risk:** There is no change in recommendations for IPC or for the use of PPE by staff when managing patients/individuals who have, or are likely to have COVID-19, or do not have a COVID-19 SARS- CoV-2 PCR test result.

• **Low risk:** Patients/individuals with no symptoms and a negative COVID-19 SARS-CoV-2 PCR test who have self-isolated prior to admission for example following NICE guidance.

LOW RISK PATIENTS		MEDIUM & HIGH RISK	
NON AGP	**AGP**	**NON AGP**	**AGP**
Standard infection control precautions		Standard infection control precautions	
Fluid Resistant Surgical Facemask		Fluid Resistant Surgical Facemask	FFP3 / Respirators
Single use gloves and apron, for direct contact with blood and body fluids only		Single use apron (wear gown if risk of spray / splashing)	Single use gown
Eye protection, risk assess and use if required when potential risk of splashing / spray of body fluids		Eye protection – Visor single use or reusable if within 2 meters of the patient	
After AGP, there is no additional requirement for ventilation or downtime in this pathway		After AGP, wait 5 minutes prior to re-entering theatre	

LOW RISK PATIENTS – ELECTIVE, TUDNO

These are the patients that we get from Tudno. They have tested negative 72hrs pre-op and been self-isolating for 14 days.

These patients will be anaesthetised in the anaesthetic room and recovered in recovery.

MEDIUM & HIGH RISK – EMERGENCIES, TRAUMA & DULAS PATIENTS

Patients from Dulas – These patients have tested negative 72 hrs pre-op but have not been self-isolating.

Trauma and emergency cases – These patients will not have self-isolated, and we don't always have the test result. All patients are going to be tested on admission. We do not wait for the result prior to sending.

WHERE TO ANAESTHETISE AND RECOVER;

Where to anaesthetise;		
Negative Covid result	**Unknown Covid result**	**Positive Covid result**
Anaesthetic Room	Anaesthetic room	Theatre

Where to recover;		
Negative Covid result	**Unknown Covid result**	**Positive Covid result**
Recovery	Recovery	Theatre

Notes:

1. Individual staff risk assessments: Staff who have been formally risk assessed as higher risk for COVID-19 please review and discuss with your line manager.
2. Ensure hand hygiene procedures are adhered to.
3. Confirm PPE requirements for each case at team brief.
4. Assess and have the appropriate staffing levels to reduce exposure.
5. Minimise usage of PPE where possible (eg try to avoid unnecessary changes of staff).
6. Use suction on diathermy. Use filters where possible for Laparoscopy.

CLASSIFICATION OF COVID RISK AEROSOL GENERATING PROCEDURES

Evidence of Covid risk AGP	**NO demonstrable transmission of Covid AGP**
- Intubation, Extubation, Mask Ventilation, open suctioning of the respiratory tract. - Supraglottic Airway (SGA) insertion if not inserted at first attempt.** - Non-invasive ventilation or CPAP. - Tracheostomy insertion and removal. - Bronchoscopy. - ENT airway procedures that involve suctioning. - Upper GI endoscopy. - Dental procedures involving high speed devices. - High flow nasal oxygen*. - Induction of sputum*. - Surgery involving high speed cutting devices in respiratory tract or paranasal sinuses surgery only*.	- Regional Anaesthesia. - Ng tube insertion. - Sedation with inhalational agents. - Chest drains. - Heavy exhalation during labour. - Diathermy. - Irrigation during surgery including pulsed lavage. - Use of a manual saw during surgery. - Abdominal Suctioning. - Amputation. - Bone drilling. - Dental procedures not involving high-speed devices. - Surgery involving high speed cutting devices other than surgery to respiratory tract or paranasal sinuses*.
** Weak evidence base for AGP.* ***No evidence for AGP. If SGA inserted on first attempt, good seal achieved and neither mask ventilation or suctioning was needed then no need to treat as an AGP. Due to risk of this not being achieved decision taken to treat as Covid risk AGP to mitigate the risk of exposure for High and Medium risk pathway patients.*	

References:

1. https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/910885/COVID-19_Infection_prevention_and_control_guidance_FINAL_PDF_20082020.pdf
2. https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng179/resources/covid19-rapid-guideline-arranging-planned-care-in-hospitals-and-diagnostic-services-pdf-66141969613765



COVID PPE guidance ICS Jul 20.pdf

3.
4. Infection prevention department Ysbyty Gwynedd.